

Matter of Light

THE PAPER KIT · TWELVE SHEETS FOR THINKING, NOT TRACKING

The workflow sheets record what happened; these decide what should. Structure is cheapest on paper — a re-ordered movement costs an eraser here and forty generations after Gate C. Each sheet is the paper twin of a bible step, in the same order the run sheet walks.

The loop

- 1 **Print** the sheet for the step you are on. Letter, portrait, black and white is fine.
- 2 **Pencil.** Thumbnail, strike out, re-order, argue in the margin. Nothing here costs a credit.
- 3 **Photograph** the marked sheet — the bible's **Paper** panel has a notes camera that keeps the photo with the step, or drop the picture straight into the Claude session.
- 4 **Iterate.** The session reads the marks, revises the prompts and the sheets, and you reprint. Each round of photo → revision is logged with the step, so the loop gets sharper as the pile grows.

What is in the kit

02	Phase 0 ledger	RUN steps 1-14 — the 42 references, in generation order
03	Gate A review	RUN step 15 — identity lock, on paper before you call it
04	Anchor string	Phase 1 — thumbnail all 39 anchors before generating one
05	Storyboard 6-up	equal frames, large — one drawing per idea
06	Storyboard 12-up	equal frames, small — alternates and coverage
07	Pulse · 12s ticks	equal TIME — 25 frames, one every 12 seconds
08	Ribbon · weighted	box width = shot length — draw inside the time you have
09	Gates B + C	contact-sheet drift hunt, then the timing lock
10	Shot cards	Phases 3-4 — draft and final passes, 23 shots
11	Methods	what wins now, and the two methods this production adds
12	Finish + submit	Phases 6-7 — the order that cannot be reversed, and the MVS

One rule: nothing on paper is canon until it is carried back into the bible. The sheet proposes; the app decides; the printed kit is regenerated from the app's own data so the two can never drift.

Phase 0 — the 42 references, in generation order

Tick when the A variant is locked; B/C/D wait for Gate A. Batch of 4, select 1. The aura rule sheet is first on purpose — it needs no identity and everything else grades against it.

RULE SHEET · 1		
☐	RULE-aura	Aura grammar — core vs hollow <i>batch</i> _____
CHARACTER · 11		
☐	REF-oriane	Oriane <i>batch</i> _____
☐	REF-oriane-damaged	Oriane — battle damage <i>batch</i> _____
☐	REF-oriane-ascended	Oriane — the ascended sta... <i>batch</i> _____
☐	REF-caedom-ascended	Caedom — the ascended f... <i>batch</i> _____
☐	REF-caedom-mortal	Caedom — the mortal form <i>batch</i> _____
☐	REF-alder	Alder — the elder brother <i>batch</i> _____
☐	REF-wren	Wren — the younger brother <i>batch</i> _____
☐	REF-threadwright	The Threadwright <i>batch</i> _____
☐	REF-keeper	The Keepers <i>batch</i> _____
☐	REF-turned	The Turned — sixteen pursuers <i>batch</i> _____
☐	LEV-rider	The fused Dominion wielder <i>batch</i> _____
STATE LADDER · 2		
☐	LADDER-oriane	Oriane — the mind ladder <i>batch</i> _____
☐	LADDER-attunement	The Turned — attunement la... <i>batch</i> _____
LESSER BEING · 7		
☐	REF-bhollow	Turned — Hollows <i>batch</i> _____
☐	REF-bwater	Turned — Water and its Phases <i>batch</i> _____
☐	REF-benergy	Turned — Energy <i>batch</i> _____
☐	REF-bgravity	Turned — Gravity <i>batch</i> _____
☐	REF-bmetal	Turned — Metals <i>batch</i> _____
☐	REF-bthral1	Turned — Thrall <i>batch</i> _____
☐	REF-banchor	Turned — Anchor <i>batch</i> _____

LIGHTING PLATE · 4		
☐	PLATE-mv1-light	Movement I — the Sun <i>batch</i> _____
☐	PLATE-mv2-light	Movement II — the Ocean <i>batch</i> _____
☐	PLATE-mv3-light	Movement III — the Island <i>batch</i> _____
☐	PLATE-mv3b	Movement III — bombardment <i>batch</i> _____
BACKGROUND · 6		
☐	BG-courtyard	Courtyard of worlds <i>batch</i> _____
☐	BG-nacre	Nacre Beach <i>batch</i> _____
☐	BG-bloom	The Corals and the abyss <i>batch</i> _____
☐	BG-vigil-temple	The white temple <i>batch</i> _____
☐	BG-keepers-isle	Keeper's Isle — the ground <i>batch</i> _____
☐	BG-machira	Machira from orbit <i>batch</i> _____
PROP · 7		
☐	PROP-shell	The aura and the light-formed pieces <i>batch</i> _____
☐	PROP-hollowstone	The Founding Stone <i>batch</i> _____
☐	PROP-coral	Leviathan coral plating <i>batch</i> _____
☐	LEV-body	The Leviathan — whole creature <i>batch</i> _____
☐	PROP-ore	Iron ore — the spears <i>batch</i> _____
☐	PROP-ships	The twelve ships <i>batch</i> _____
☐	PROP-tear	The frozen tear <i>batch</i> _____
EFFECT · 4		
☐	FX-hollow	The hollow — base unit of her power <i>batch</i> _____
☐	FX-mind	The segmented mind <i>batch</i> _____
☐	FX-mountain	The floating mountain <i>batch</i> _____
☐	FX-strike-blast	The kill beat — strike and blast <i>batch</i> _____

Gate A — identity lock, argued on paper first

An anchor built on an unlocked face gets rebuilt thirty-nine times. Before you call this gate, write — in pencil, from memory, without the screen — the three features per identity that must never move. Then open the references and see if the sheets agree with you.

IDENTITY	MUST NOT MOVE	WHAT MOVED (PENCIL)
ORIANE	brows squared at the inner edge · pale blue-grey eyes · crystal is aura over cloth, never skin	
CAEDOM	same bone structure in both forms · white light irises, no beam · never brightens	
ALDER — nineteen	blonde, longer face, watchful · mouth closed · same height as his brother	
WREN — eighteen	brunette, rounder face, mid-speech · same height — age reads in features, never stature	

The lock list

- ☐ Every reference on one screen, side by side — hunt for a face that moved
- ☐ Brothers height check: both A sheets together, identical stature, non-negotiable
- ☐ Aura rule holds everywhere: adept hollow at the centre, bearer lit from within
- ☐ Every character against its movement's lighting plate — plastic shows here first
- ☐ Damage fixed at exactly three marks on Oriane — reject any frame with a fourth
- ☐ No colour in Movement II references except the crystal and the seam-light

Passing this gate closed: date _____ · what you re-rolled to pass it _____

Phase 1 — thumbnail the string before you generate it

All 39 anchors in film order. Dashed boxes are shared joins or matched pairs — one drawing serves two shots, so draw it once and mean it. Grey boxes are the two authored bridges and must go genuinely near-black. Read the finished page as a comic strip: if the story fails here it fails in motion at forty times the price.

F01 S1 A	F02 S1 B / S2 A · shared	F03 S2 B	F04 S3 A
F05 S3 B	F06 S4 A	F07 S4 B	F08 S5 A
F09 S5 B · match	F10 S6 A · match	F11 S6 B / S7 A · shared	F12 S7 B / S8 A · shared
F13 S8 B	F14 S9 A	F15 S9 B	F16 S10 A
F17 S10 B / S11 A · shared	B01 S11 B / S12 A · BRIDGE	F18 S12 B	F19 S13 A
F20 S13 B	F21 S14 A	F22 S14 B · match	F23 S15 A · match
F24 S15 B	F25 S16 A	F26 S16 B	F27 S17 A
F28 S17 B	F29 S18 A	B02 S18 B / S19 A · BRIDGE	F30 S19 B / S20 A · shared
F31 S20 B	F32 S21 A	F33 S21 B	F34 S22 A
F35 S22 B	F36 S23 A	F37 S23 B	

Storyboard — six equal frames

One drawing per idea, at a size where a composition can actually be judged. All frames 2.39:1. Use it for the shots that carry the film — F35, the mountain, the vortex — and for arguing a variant against the specced version before either is generated.

shot _____ · sec ____ · seam out _____	shot _____ · sec ____ · seam out _____
shot _____ · sec ____ · seam out _____	shot _____ · sec ____ · seam out _____
shot _____ · sec ____ · seam out _____	shot _____ · sec ____ · seam out _____

Storyboard — twelve equal frames

Coverage and alternates: four takes on one shot, or a whole movement at a glance. Small on purpose — if an idea does not read at this size it will not read at speed on screen either.

shot _____ · _____	shot _____ · _____	shot _____ · _____
shot _____ · _____	shot _____ · _____	shot _____ · _____
shot _____ · _____	shot _____ · _____	shot _____ · _____
shot _____ · _____	shot _____ · _____	shot _____ · _____

Thumbnail discipline: silhouette first, camera height second, light direction third. No faces at this scale — a face drawn here is detail hiding a composition that has not been decided.

The pulse — one frame every twelve seconds

Equal time between frames, whatever the shots are doing: 25 ticks across the full 5:00. Sketch what is actually on screen at each tick. This is the pacing read the shot list cannot give you — when three adjacent ticks draw the same held composition, the hold is spending 24+ seconds, and it had better be S1, S13 or S20. When every tick is a new sketch, you have built a trailer.

0:00 · S1 · MV1	0:12 · S1 · MV1	0:24 · S2 · MV1	0:36 · S3 · MV1	0:48 · S4 · MV1
1:00 · S4 · MV1	1:12 · S5 · MV1	1:24 · S6 · MV2	1:36 · S7 · MV2	1:48 · S8 · MV2
2:00 · S9 · MV2	2:12 · S10 · MV2	2:24 · S10 · MV2	2:36 · S11 · MV2	2:48 · S12 · MV2
3:00 · S13 · MV2	3:12 · S14 · MV2	3:24 · S15 · MV3	3:36 · S16 · MV3	3:48 · S17 · MV3
4:00 · S18 · MV3	4:12 · S20 · MV3	4:24 · S20 · MV3	4:36 · S22 · MV3	4:48 · S23 · MV3

Read it in one pass: the eye should snag exactly where the film means it to — the first cut (0:48), the silence (S13), the empty frame after S14, the push on the older brother. Circle any snag the film did not intend.

The ribbon — box width is shot length

Every box is drawn at the width of its screen time (0.150"/s), wrapping like text. A 16-second hold gives you a wide panel and demands a composition that survives it; an 8-second aftermath gives you a sliver and forbids one. Draw inside the time you actually have — the sheet makes over-designing a short shot physically uncomfortable, which is the point. Top border: solid = Movement I, double = II, dotted = III.

S1 · 16s

S2 · 18s

S3 · 14s

S4 · 14s

S5 · 18s

S6 · 14s

S7 · 12s

S8 · 14s

S9 · 12s

S10 · 16s

S11 · 10s

S12 · 12s

S13 · 15s

S14 · 13s

S15 · 12s

S16 · 12s

S17 · 10s

S18 · 10s

S19 · 10s

S20 · 14s

S21 · 8s

S22 · 14s

S23 · 12s

Two uses: thumbnail the whole film in order at true proportion, or cut the boxes out and re-order them on the desk — the interleave of the swim and the battle was decided exactly this way. Re-ordering here costs scissors; after Gate C it costs generations.

Gate B — the drift hunt

All 39 anchors on one contact sheet, read left to right, twice. Fixing a jump here costs an image; fixing it after Gate C costs a shot. Work the list with a pencil — an unticked line is an open gate.

- ☐ Face — any identity whose features moved between neighbouring anchors
- ☐ Costume — damage marks, seam-light, robe construction identical across joins
- ☐ Light — key direction agrees with the movement's plate in every frame
- ☐ Grade — no warm tone anywhere in Movement II; island only warms at golden hour
- ☐ Shared joins — F11, F12, F17 read correctly as the END of one shot and the START of the next
- ☐ Match pairs — F09/F10 and F22/F23 agree on shape, scale and colour
- ☐ Bridges — B01 and B02 go genuinely near-black; 70% obscured reads as a failed hide

Gate C — the timing lock

Cut the stills reel, watch all five minutes without stopping, then freeze. Note the timecode of every reach-for-the-phone moment before deciding anything.

BLOCK	TARGET	ACTUAL	NOTE
Movement I	80s	<i>actual</i> _____	five shots, first cut at 0:48
Movement II	118s	<i>actual</i> _____	generated in strict sequence — the chain is the shot
Movement III	102s	<i>actual</i> _____	locked-off witness; the only push is the last

Cost table, after this gate: re-order two shots $\approx$ 2 images before $\cdot \approx$ 80 generations after. Insert $\approx$ 3 before $\cdot \approx$ 120 after. The lock is the last cheap moment — date closed _____

Phases 3–4 — the 23 generations, draft then final

Draft box ticks at Gate D (does the seam read? can the model reach the B-frame?); final box ticks when the shot ships. Attempts in pencil — three failures and the shot leaves the queue for the escalation ladder, and the promoted-frame column records any draft frame that beat its anchor.

ID	TC	DUR	SHOT	MODEL	SEAM INTO NEXT	DRFT	FIN	ATT · PROM
S1	0:00	16s	Rise out of the fire	wan3_0	Continuous into S2 — do not render these separately unle...	☐	☐	_____
S2	0:16	18s	The courtyard of worlds	seedance_2_5	Extend S1 forward. The seam is inside the glare — invisi...	☐	☐	_____
S3	0:34	14s	“There must be risk”	cinematic_studio_3_0	Cut on her turning her head. Motivated: new point of view.	☐	☐	_____
S4	0:48	14s	“He’s your brother”	minimax_hailuo (2.3)	No seam. This shot’s job is to make the audience feel th...	☐	☐	_____
S5	1:02	18s	“Tomorrow” — the tear freezes	cinematic_studio_3_0	Ends on the frozen tear in macro. That facet becomes the...	☐	☐	_____
S6	1:20	14s	108 years later — the run	cinematic_studio_video_v2	Match cut in from the tear’s facet: blue interior become...	☐	☐	_____
S7	1:34	12s	Sixteen behind her, and a wall of ice	kling3_0	End frame: her body flat against the ice wall. That fram...	☐	☐	_____
S8	1:46	14s	Up the wall	cinematic_studio_video_v2	Starts on S7’s end frame. Ends as the ice wall collapses...	☐	☐	_____
S9	2:00	12s	The threadwright’s eyes	veo3_1	Motivated cut: a new point of view. The only reason a cu...	☐	☐	_____
S10	2:12	16s	The leviathan	seedance_2_0	None. Awe requires duration; a cut here destroys the sho...	☐	☐	_____
S11	2:28	10s	Running the flank	kling3_0	Ends with the leviathan’s flank filling frame to near-bl...	☐	☐	_____
S12	2:38	12s	The lightning river	cinematic_studio_video_v2	Pull off matching darkness. The audience will not regist...	☐	☐	_____
S13	2:50	15s	The vortex, from the Sun	wan3_0	Hard cut to scale. The film’s biggest moment is its quie...	☐	☐	_____
S14	3:05	13s	The Stone leaves her	cinematic_studio_3_0	The Stone’s streak across the sky is the transition into...	☐	☐	_____
S15	3:18	12s	Nacre Beach — the same sun	cinematic_studio_3_0	In the interleaved cut this shot plays early, inside Mov...	☐	☐	_____
S16	3:30	12s	Over the abyss	kling2_6	Straight cut, time passing. Permitted: a jump in place.	☐	☐	_____
S17	3:42	10s	Twelve ships	cinematic_studio_3_0	Cut on the tremor — a revelation the current frame canno...	☐	☐	_____
S18	3:52	10s	The Temple does not answer	cinematic_studio_video_v2	Internal cuts only. Nothing leaves the generation.	☐	☐	_____
S19	4:02	10s	The Keepers kneel	seedance_2_0	Dust wall obscures everything to brown shadow. Cut insid...	☐	☐	_____
S20	4:12	14s	The mountain	wan3_0	None permitted. Cutting this shot is the single worst de...	☐	☐	_____
S21	4:26	8s	The garden replants itself	veo3_1_lite	Straight cut on stillness.	☐	☐	_____
S22	4:34	14s	What Alder saw	veo3_1	Wren’s voice fades under, and Alder’s own want arrives a...	☐	☐	_____
S23	4:48	12s	Tomorrow, again	cinematic_studio_3_0	Closes the loop opened in S1. The last image is the fis...	☐	☐	_____

Methods — what wins now, and what this production adds

The first table is current best practice on the platform, as used by strong entrants and documented in the bible. The two boxed methods are this production's additions — one better than practice, one best available. Both were adversarially reviewed before they were written down; their qualifications are part of the method.

Image-first anchor string	decide the film as ~39 stills before any video; motion animates decisions already made
End→start frame chaining	shot N's last frame is N+1's literal first — continuity by construction, drift watched per link
Forward extension	feed the finished clip back in and continue the take (+30s) — the oner engine, 720p tax paid at finish
Multi-shot in one generation	several angles inside one generation hold world, wardrobe and light constant across their own cuts
Ramps and body wipes	speed ramps and near-black wipes deliver a cut's accent without leaving the frame
Motion control	drive a still character with a reference clip — choreography becomes repeatable instead of rerolled
Cheap-pass previz + promotion	every shot at budget tier first; any draft frame that beats its anchor is promoted into the ledger
Deflicker → upscale → grade	in that order, always — the reverse bakes shimmer into the master permanently

BETTER

The sketch-lock loop

1. Compose on the printed 21:9 frames (sheets 04–08) until silhouette, camera height and light direction are decided. Draw inside the frame — a photo of an unframed sketch silently re-centres when a model crops it.
2. Photograph the winner (bible → Paper → notes camera). From then on the sketch is the shot's **judging target**: every batch is selected against the drawing; a re-roll that drifts is rejected on sight. Zero rules risk — nothing external enters the project.
3. Prompt-only first. Escalate to sketch-as-reference only for stubborn layout (shot size, figure placement, the two match-cut pairs) after ~two failed batches — via the multi-reference image lane (nano_banana_pro) to build a photoreal comp draft. Never in the soul_2 lane: its one reference slot belongs to the lighting plate.
4. When a sketch goes in: “framing, shot size and figure placement only; render photoreal; match the movement plate; no graphite, no monochrome, no paper texture.” Sketch bleed is a hard reject. Confirm on the rules page that hand-drawn reference inputs are permitted — every input publishes with the history.

***Qualifications:** claims precision, never credit savings — free iteration already exists on unlimited-trial models. A drawing states a composition a prompt cannot; the discipline is that the sketch stays a target by default.*

Paper wins when a composition is easier to draw than to describe — stubborn framing, matched cuts, exact figure placement — and the sketch stays a target, not an upload.

BEST

The re-anchor budget

1. Classify every join at string time: **designed anchor** (drift resets), **inherited frame** (pixel-exact start, drift-from-design accrues), or **authored bridge** (near-black or blinding — drift absorbed).
2. **Never more than two consecutive inherited joins.** A third means promote the join to a designed anchor, or spend a bridge. This film's longest runs — S6–S8 and S10–S12 — are exactly two links; the budget makes the accident a law.
3. Inherit **start frames only** — starts inherit pixel-exactly, end frames land approximately on every chainable model. Never chain onto an extracted end frame.
4. Between resets, sub-chains are independent: strict order lives inside a sub-chain, so S6–S8, S10–S12 and the standalones can generate in parallel.
5. At Gate D, measure each draft's landing against its designed end anchor; promote better frames in inheritance order only.

***Reviewed and rejected on the way here:** building a long chain from both ends toward a designed midpoint — it relocates error rather than halving it, and forces earlier shots to end on extracted frames, trading exact inheritance for approximate. The budget generalises what bridge B01 already does at S11→S12.*

Phase 6 — the order that cannot be reversed

Four steps, strictly in order. Upscaling a flickering shot upscales the flicker, and there is no route back from it.

- | | | |
|---|---|--------------------------|
| 1 | Deflicker every extended and chained shot — the seams shimmer and this is the only pass that removes it | ☐ |
| 2 | Upscale to 2K/4K with the aigc preset — after deflicker, never before | ☐ |
| 3 | Grade — three looks, one per movement: gold-on-black · cold blue-grey · golden hour | ☐ |
| 4 | Gate E — picture lock. Anything still wrong is a sound problem, or it ships | ☐ |

Phase 7 — the list that disqualifies

Every line is a rule with teeth. An entry missing an MVS component does not compete and is not published.

- | | |
|--------------------------|---|
| ☐ | Official watermark + packshot on the final video |
| ☐ | Public post (IG / YT / X / Reddit) — film with both intact, account public and staying public |
| ☐ | Post AND account load in a logged-out browser window |
| ☐ | Every asset still inside the submission project — deleted nothing |
| ☐ | All prompts read as a stranger would — no novel term anywhere, they get published |
| ☐ | English subtitles or VO for all dialogue · MP4/MOV · ≤4K · 21:9 |
| ☐ | S13 still ships silent — protect it from every instinct to fill it |
| ☐ | End card: “Original screen story by B.L. Barkey” · adapted-from credit in the description |
| ☐ | Submitted with a full day of margin — deadline night is not when you find a scope problem |

Sign-off: submitted _____ · public post URL _____